The Handoff Map

Find the few things only you should be doing,
give everything else to AI, and stay the director.

Your time is the one asset you cannot make more of. Spend it on purpose.

Doing it yourself is not the same as doing it well.

Buying back your time is not about being too good for a task. It is about spending your hours on the few things you are best suited to do.

For a founder with ADHD this matters twice. Attention is the scarce resource, and it does not arrive on schedule. The hours when you are sharp are worth far more than the hours when you are not, so spending them on admin is the most expensive way to work.

Operator

Does every task by hand. Is always busy. Is the bottleneck in their own business.

Director

Decides what good looks like, briefs AI, reviews the result. Keeps their best hours for the work only they can do.

Systems over discipline: do not try to try harder, hand it off.

Map your week.

Write down everything you touched in the last seven days. Then put each item in one column.

1 **Mine.** Needs your taste, your voice, your relationships or your final call. Aim for five items or fewer.

2 **AI's.** Repeatable, describable, checkable. Drafts, replies, research, scheduling, formatting, reports, first passes.

3 **Gone.** Nobody would notice if it stopped. Cross it out and do not hand it to anyone.

SORT IT FOR ME

```
Here is everything I did last week: [paste, messy is fine]. Sort it
into three lists: things only I can do because they need my taste,
voice or final decision; things an AI assistant could do with a clear
brief; and things that can simply be dropped. For each item in the
middle list, say what you would need from me to do it.
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Write the handoff once.

A job you can describe is a job you can hand off. Describe it one time and it runs every week.

THE HANDOFF BRIEF

```
You are taking over this job: [name it]. What good looks like: [two
or three sentences, include an example if you have one]. What you can
decide on your own: [list]. What you must bring to me first: [list].
How I want the result: [format, length, tone]. Before you start, ask
me up to three questions if anything is unclear. Then do the first
one.
```

Three rules for a good brief

1. **Show, do not explain.** Paste one example of work you like. It does more than a paragraph of rules.

2. **Set the edges.** Say what it can decide and what comes back to you.

3. **Keep the brief.** Save it somewhere you can paste from. The second run should cost you ten seconds.

Direct. Do not operate.

Directing is a short loop: look at the work, say what is off, send it back. It is not redoing the work yourself.

REVIEW THE WORK

```
Here is what you produced this week: [paste]. Check it against the brief. List where it missed, what you assumed, and what you would change. Then give me a revised brief that would have prevented each miss.
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UPDATE THE MAP

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Here is my Handoff Map from last week and what changed: [paste]. Which job should I hand off next, which job should I take back, and what is one thing on my own list that I could shrink or drop?
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PROTECT MY BEST HOURS

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These are the hours I do my best work: [list]. Here is next week's calendar: [paste]. Show me which meetings and tasks are sitting inside those hours, and suggest what to move out of them.
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Three things, in order.

1 **Today:** run Sort it for me on last week. Twenty minutes, mess is fine.

2 **This week:** pick the one job from the middle list that annoys you most and write its handoff brief. Run it once and review.

3 **Friday:** run Review the work, then Update the map. Add one new handoff, never more.

One handoff a week is enough. In two months you will have a team of briefs, and your best hours will go to the work only you can do.

A working method to adapt: change the words until they sound like you. Always read what AI produces before it goes out under your name.

Not too good for the task. Just better used somewhere else.